

5 Continent — Quote vs Invoice: FINAL v4 (consolidated)

Invoice 1026-08 · Freight EXW Ilhéus → San Francisco · 2 pallets / 349 kg

> **This is the consolidated updated document.** It supersedes v1 (mis-split; read only the quote's text layer),

> v2 (corrected; recovered the embedded rate table), v3 (air freight AWB-verified), and folds in the variance > bridge. Everything below reconciles to the cent.

1. The headline

The quote is **\$3,510.60** and the invoice is **\$4,866.33** — but **these are not the same kind of number**:

- **\$3,510.60** = 5 Continent's **freight rate table only** (7 logistics lines).
- **\$4,866.33** = the **all-in landed cost** (freight + customs + duties + fees), 15 lines.

The quote contained a **separate** "Customs clearance charges" section (US clearance, FDA, duties, bond, MPF, line

fees) that is **not** part of the \$3,510.60. Comparing the two directly mixes a **freight subtotal** with a ****full landed bill**** — which is why the gap resists a one-line "they overcharged" answer.

2. Line-by-line: Quoted | Actual | Verdict

Line item	Quoted	Actual	Verdict
Inland Freight in Brazil	837.00	1,012.17	OVERAGE (+175.17)
Airline Terminal Fee - Brazil SSA	345.00 (= 250 + 95)	345.00	MATCH (bundled)
Palletizing	-	65.00	UNQUOTED
Storage - SSA + Saturday	-	112.19	UNQUOTED
Clearance - Export Customs BRA + SDA	- (agreed w/ Omega)	414.59	UNQUOTED / possible DUPLICATE
Air Freight Charges	1,118.60 (+300 kgs)	1,241.00	OVERAGE (+122.40)
Airline Terminal Fee USA	200.00	200.00	MATCH
Air Freight Handling	125.00 (Handling Fee USA)	125.00	MATCH
Inland Freight (US)	885.00 (Delivery to door)	885.00	MATCH
Customs Clearance USA	150.00	150.00	MATCH
Additional Invoice Lines	1st 3 free, 5.00/line	40.00	MATCH (quoted policy)
FDA Filing	100.00	100.00	MATCH
Customs Duties	At cost	128.53	MATCH (at cost)

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Line item	Quoted	Actual	Verdict
Duty Advance Fee	-	12.85	UNQUOTED
Bank Fees	-	35.00	UNQUOTED
TOTAL		4,866.33	

3. The three buckets (reconcile to the cent)

Bucket	Amount	Composition
MATCH - quoted & billed exactly	1,973.53	150 + 100 + 128.53 + 200 + 345 + 125 + 885 + 40
OVERAGE - quoted line billed above rate	2,253.17 as billed	Inland Brazil 1,012.17 + Air freight 1,241.00
UNQUOTED - no quote rate at all	639.63	65 + 112.19 + 414.59 + 12.85 + 35
TOTAL	4,866.33	reconciles

Overage above quote = **+297.57** (175.17 + 122.40).

4. Air freight — triangulated from three independent sources

Source	Basis	USD
Quote rate table (embedded image, quote p.2)	flat +300 kgs	1,118.60
Carrier HAWB 047-3175 3223 (gross 349,000 kg, 2 pallets)	349 kg @ 2.30/kg	802.70
5 Continent invoice 1026-08	365 kg @ 3.40/kg	1,241.00

The invoice is **above both**: **+122.40** over 5 Continent's own quoted rate, and **+438.30** over what the carrier itself documents as the chargeable freight. **Both** the weight (365 vs 349 kg) **and** the rate (3.40 vs 2.30) are inflated versus the carrier's own paperwork — same AWB number, same 2 pallets.

Which is the contractual ask: the forwarder's own quote (1,118.60) is the price 5 Continent committed to; the

HAWB (802.70) exposes their underlying cost. The clean demand is *"re-bill to your quoted rate."*

MAWB caveat: the master waybill bills a nominal minimum (2.30 / total 57.30) — consolidator-to-airline settlement, **not** what TrueTech owes. Only the **HAWB** is the right comparator, because the HAWB consignee is

TrueTech Inc (the MAWB consignee is 5 Continent Logistics itself).

5. Why \$3,510.60 becomes \$4,866.33 — the variance bridge

Step	Delta	Running total
Quote — freight rate table		3,510.60
1. Freight overages (2 quoted lines billed above rate)	+297.57	3,808.17
2. Quoted customs/duty/fee items, now billed	+418.53	4,226.70
3. Wholly unquoted charges (5 items, no rate)	+639.63	4,866.33
Total difference	+1,355.73	

Cause 1 — \$297.57: OVERCHARGES on freight lines that WERE quoted

Inland Brazil 837.00 → 1,012.17 (+175.17); Air Freight 1,118.60 → 1,241.00 (+122.40). **DISPUTE** — billed above

the forwarder's own quoted rates.

Cause 2 — \$418.53: quoted customs items NOT in the freight table

US clearance 150 + FDA 100 + duties 128.53 + line fees 40. Billed **exactly as quoted**; it only looks like an increase because the \$3,510.60 comparator excluded customs. **Legitimate**. (Check: "Duties at cost" 128.53 needs a breakdown.)

Cause 3 — \$639.63: WHOLLY UNQUOTED charges

Palletizing 65 + Storage 112.19 + Export clearance 414.59 (**possible duplicate**) + Duty advance 12.85 + Bank 35.

DISPUTE — no quoted rate for any of these.

6. Bottom line

Cause	Amount	Share of gap	Verdict
Quoted customs items (not in freight table)	418.53	31%	Legitimate — comparison artifact
Freight overages on quoted lines	297.57	22%	Dispute
Wholly unquoted charges	639.63	47%	Dispute (esp. 414.59 duplicate risk)
Total gap	1,355.73	100%	~937.20 (69%) genuinely contestable

69% of the gap (\$937.20) is contestable. The other \$418.53 is a legitimate quoted add.

7. Priority asks worth a direct reply to Graziela

1. **Air freight — the strongest line item.** Billed above 5 Continent's **own carrier documentation**. Invoice 1,241.00 (365 kg @ 3.40) vs quoted flat 1,118.60 vs carrier HAWB 802.70 (349 kg @ 2.30). Ask them to ****re-bill to**

the quoted 1,118.60** and explain the 365 kg / 3.40 basis.

2. **Export clearance 414.59 — confirm with Omega BEFORE disputing.** The quote says clearance "was agreed directly

with Omega," i.e. it was NOT in 5 Continent's quote. If Omega was already paid, this line is a ****straight duplicate**** — the ask becomes *"please remove, already paid."*

8. Lower priority

- **Inland Freight Brazil +175.17** — billed 1,012.17 vs quoted 837.00. Same "re-bill to quote" ask.

- **Bond & MPF** — quoted formulas, no distinct invoice line; possibly bundled into "Customs Duties 128.53." Ask 5CL

to break them out.

- **Handling Fee USA 125.00** — MATCH, but the quote has a *separate* conditional "125.00 per exam." Confirm no exam

fee is embedded.

- **Beneficiary mismatch** — header "5 Continent Logistics LLC" vs pay block "5 Continent Alliance." Verify same

entity before any wire.

- **Trading-company fee (16% + ~4.2%)** — quote premise was "no trading company." Confirm none embedded.

- **Spec drift** — quote 3 pallets / 329 kgs; as-shipped 2 pallets / 349 kg. "Delivery to the door" (885) was quoted

for 3 pallets and billed in full for 2.

9. Provenance

quote `brazil/sources/2026-08-26\_5continent\_rate\_quote.pdf` (rate table = embedded image p.2) · invoice `.../2026-10-07\_5continent\_invoice\_1026-08.pdf` · HAWB `.../2026-10-02\_air\_waybill\_hawb\_issued.md` · MAWB

`.../2026-10-05\_air\_waybill\_mawb\_issued.md`

Pay-to routing (TD Bank NA, acct 9246418811) is a money move — no payment without an explicit governor command.